Healthcare Product Management

Module 5: Designing the Product Concept *(Not the Features)*

In healthcare, a product is a mechanism for change, not a collection of buttons and screens.

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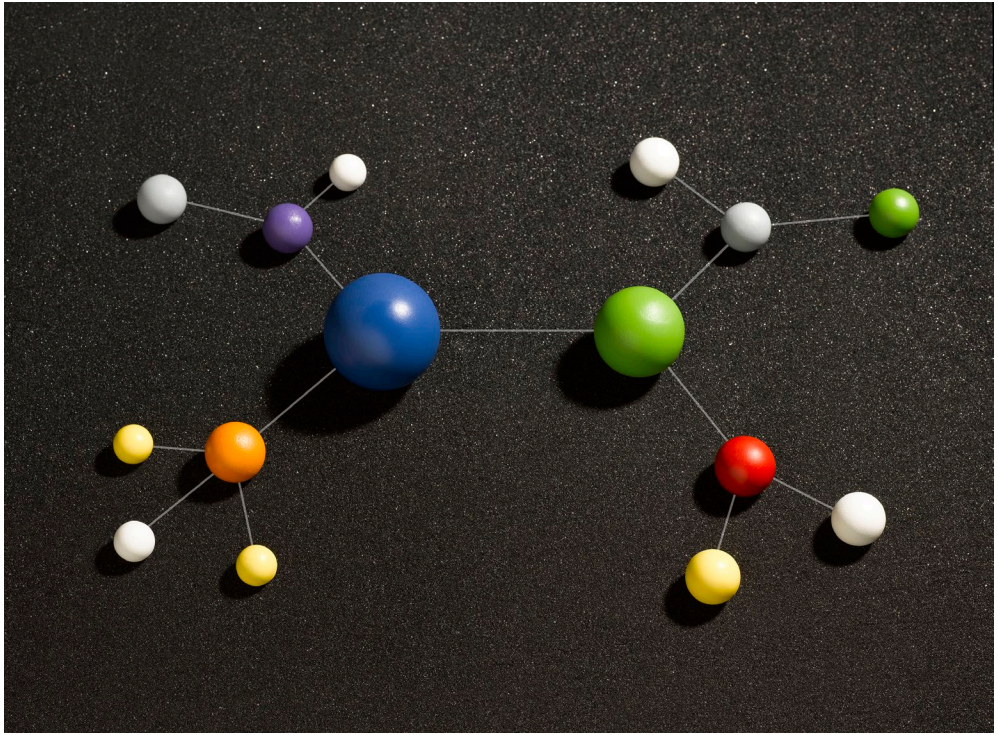


Course Outline

A product concept is a **clear, constrained explanation of how a product changes outcomes in a real healthcare system—without yet describing how it is built.**

“Up to now, you’ve defined the problem, the thinking shift, the stakeholders, and the constraints.

In this module, you articulate the product’s *intent*—not its implementation.”

Bad Example

Decision Support

- An **AI-powered tool** that increases diagnostic accuracy and improves provider decision-making in the ED

- Overclaims AI
- Automates clinician role
- Unclear where it fits

VS.

Good Example

Decision Support

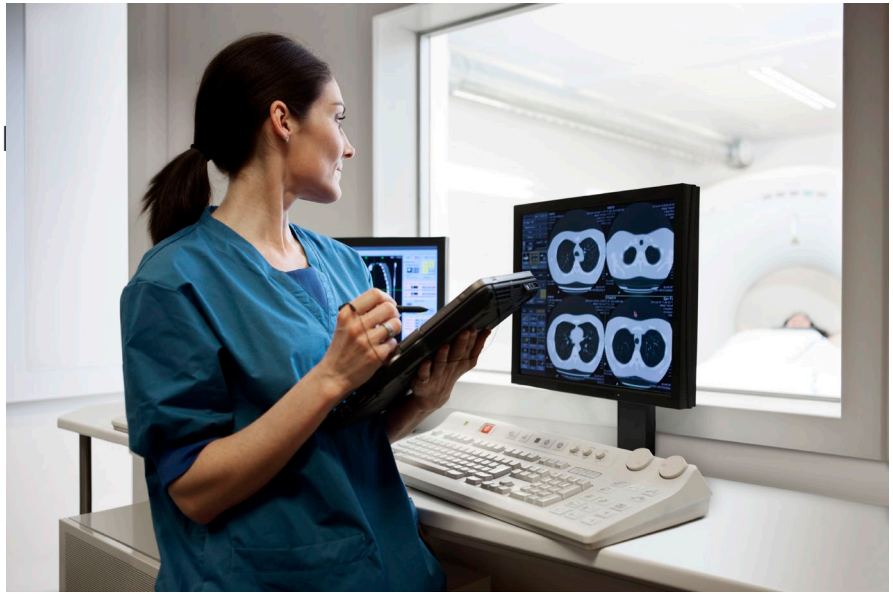
Assists emergency physicians during triage by surfacing risk-relevant patient history at point of decision, helping prioritize **without making** diagnostic recommendations

- **Humility & clarity**
- **Supports, doesn't replace**
- Anchored to triage

From Problem to Product Concept

A healthcare product concept is also a hypothesis about how a specific intervention will solve a defined problem.

- The "Mechanism of Action": How exactly does the tool change a clinician's decision or a patient's behavior?
- Core Value Proposition: The unique benefit that justifies the cost, risk, and effort of adoption.
- Workflow Change: Mapping the "Before" vs. "After" to identify where the friction is removed or added.



Artifact Prep: Draft your core value proposition—what is the single most important change your product creates?

Healthcare Risk and Safety Thinking

Safety is not a "feature"; it is the foundation upon which every healthcare product concept must be built.

- Identifying "Failure Modes": What happens if the tool is wron slow, or unavailable?
- The "Do No Harm" Test: Does the product introduce new risks (e.g., alert fatigue, data silos)?
- Mitigation by Design: Building safety checks into the core logic the product concept.

Artifact Prep: Identify the top two safety risks of your concept and how you will mitigate them.

Defining Success Without Vanity Metrics

Meaningful healthcare metrics measure clinical outcomes, safety, or operational efficiency, not just "engagement."

Vanity Metrics (Avoid)

- Logins, clicks, and "time in app" often signal friction, not value.
- High engagement can be a sign of a poorly designed, time-consuming tool.

Meaningful Metrics (Target)

- Reduction in readmissions, time to treatment, or diagnostic accuracy.
- The "North Star" Metric: The one indicator reflecting core value.

Artifact Prep: Metric Definition

Define one clinical or operational success metric for your product concept. How will you prove that your intervention actually solved the problem?

The "Decision Change" Framework

If your product doesn't change a decision or a workflow, it doesn't have a reason to exist.

Current Decision

What decision is being made today? (e.g., "Should I admit this patient?")

Product Intervention

How does your product change that decision? (e.g., "Providing real-time risk scores to support home-based care.")

Resulting Impact

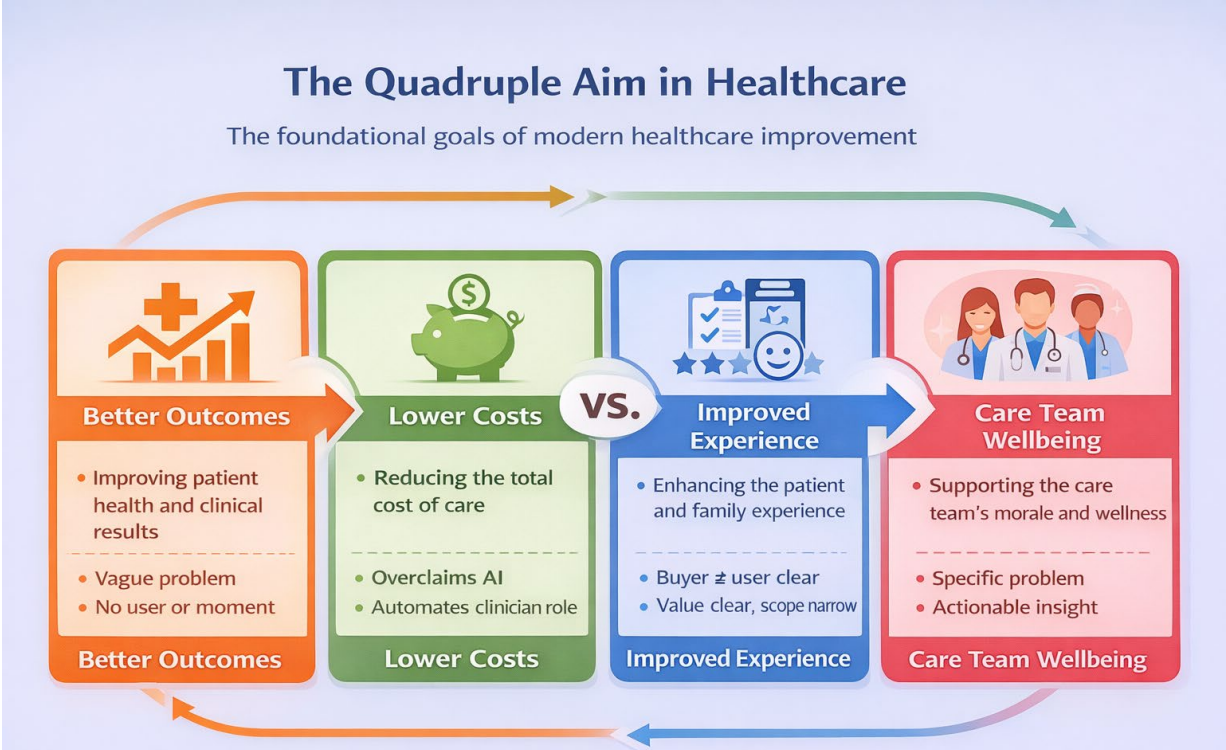
What is the impact of that change? (e.g., "Reduced hospital crowding and lower costs.")

Judgment Call: Status Quo Bias

Is *the change significant enough to overcome the "status quo" bias?*

Remind yourself that "doing nothing" is the most common competitor in healthcare.

A healthcare product concept must be anchored in the “Quadruple Aim": better care, better health, provider well being and lower costs.



Reflection question: Which of the 4 goals is your product concept addressing

The "Safety-First" Product Logic

High-judgment healthcare products must prioritize "Safe Failure" over "Fast Success."

- **Human-in-the-Loop:** When should the product defer to clinical judgment vs. automating a task?
- **Transparency and Explainability:** Does the user understand *why* the product is making a recommendation?
- **Feedback Loops:** How does the product learn from its mistakes or from user overrides?

PM Responsibility: You are the "Chief Safety Officer" for your product concept.

Artifact Checkpoint: What You Should Have So Far

Your artifact should now have a robust "Product Concept & Success Criteria" section.

- **Core Value Proposition**
  A clear statement of the primary benefit your product provides.
- **Workflow/Decision Change**
  A description of the "Before" and "After" clinical or operational state.
- **Key Safety Considerations**
  Identified risks and specific mitigation strategies built into the concept.
- **Meaningful Success Metrics**
  Clinical or operational indicators that prove the prod

Summary: Concept as Strategy

A well-defined product concept is your most powerful tool for alignment and execution.

Concept vs. Features

Concepts provide the "Why" and "How" before the "What." Focus on the mechanism of change, not just the collection of buttons.

Safety Foundation

Safety is a core design parameter, not an afterthought. Prioritize "Safe Failure" over "Fast Success" in high-judgment environments.

Impact Metrics

Success is measured by clinical or operational impact, not vanity engagement. If it doesn't change a decision, it doesn't have value.

Next Module: Validating Clinical Fit Before You Build